False start 2 — Juniper Mesa uranium property

Document ID: SH-PS-FS-002 | **Version:** 1.0.0

Event/effective date: 2024-06-14 | **Available to case company:** 2024-06-14

Created at: 2026-09-05T22:16:52-07:00 | **Publication cutoff:** 2026-09-05T23:59:59-07:00

Fictional author: Evan Vilander, with Mari Varela's operating review

Record origin: SYNTHETIC_COMPANY_ANALYSIS | **Evidence state:** SYNTHETIC_RECONSTRUCTED

Decision state: LOCKED_DERIVED_IMPLEMENTATION of the approved second failure

Juniper Mesa is a fictional western New Mexico uranium-property opportunity sold by fictional Mesa Lantern Minerals, LLC. Its name, seller, figures and documents are authored case detail. It has no canonical surveyed coordinate, no Sable Harbor ownership and no approved production in this corpus.

Initial proposition — March 4, 2024

The seller proposed $6M for project rights, cited historical drilling with attractive grades and suggested first production within thirty months. After Cedar Junction, Vilander believed a deposit with a lower entry price might avoid the expensive downstream restart trap. He brought geological and operating specialists into the first review rather than waiting for a favored model to form.

That improvement did not prevent a new error. He still treated the low price as reducing total risk before testing the route from resource to saleable product. The seller's headline drilling supported a mineralized occurrence. It did not establish water access, economically mineable material, processing response or a feasible production schedule.

Evidence register

ID / availability	Artifact and claim	Reliability boundary / finding
JM-01 / 2024-03-04	Seller project summary: $6M entry; thirty-month production	Explicit seller forecast; no unconditional production commitment
JM-02 / 2024-03-22	Geological review of selected historical holes	Mineralization credible in reviewed holes; continuity and sampling support insufficient for the seller's full commercial case
JM-03 / 2024-04-05	Water memorandum and access-title matrix	Water arrangements were contingent; the apparent direct access crossed rights not controlled by the seller
JM-04 / 2024-04-19	Bench-test review	Small preferred samples did not represent carbonate-rich and variable feed; acid demand and recovery sensitivity needed more work
JM-05 / 2024-05-10	Integrated schedule, version 2	Water, access and process demonstration drove a six-to-eight-year planning range, not thirty months
JM-06 / 2024-05-31	Seller response	Seller maintained the shorter schedule but did not supply the missing rights or representative process evidence

The schedule range is an analyst scenario, not an official permit forecast. No regulator denial is invented. Incomplete evidence is not proof that the property can never be developed; it is a reason not to price an early-production case as established.

Decision and preserved disagreement

Vilander's June 7 draft separated geological confidence from commercial confidence. The review could support further geological work while rejecting the seller's timing and capital story. Mari argued that buying first would make every later inquiry an exercise in defending sunk cost. A commercial reviewer favored a contingent option, but the seller required a substantial nonrefundable payment without providing the water/access conditions needed to protect it.

Kill criteria were: no purchase on a production date dependent on unheld rights; no base valuation from unrepresentative process tests; and no assumed recovery of sunk capital through later enthusiasm. On June 14 Vilander closed the acquisition recommendation. The company retained the file for future comparison and made no acquisition commitment.

After-action lesson

The positive change was earlier specialist involvement. The remaining weakness was treating entry price as the whole economic exposure. The next case had to show a path through permissions, representative processing evidence, construction/rehabilitation scope and a funded schedule. For Red Wash, existing infrastructure would count only if condition and operating access survived inspection. “Brownfield” became a question about usable capability, not a shortcut to low risk.

Related records: Cedar Junction, Salt Rim, Red Wash AAR.